

Daily Life in China

How to Borrow a Shared Power Bank in China (2026)

CDISCOVERY

<https://cdiscovery-community.netlify.app/>

How to Borrow a Shared Power Bank in China (2026)

Shared power banks (共享充电宝) are everywhere in China -- at restaurants, malls, bars, airports, and train stations. If your phone is dying and you forgot your charger, these rental stations are a lifesaver. Here is how the system works.

What Are Shared Power Banks?

Shared power banks are portable battery packs housed in rental stations. You scan a QR code, pay a small fee, take a power bank with built-in cables, use it while you're out, and return it to any station of the same brand. It's as simple as renting a shared bicycle.

Major Brands

* 怪兽充电 (Energy Monster)

* -- Largest market share, found in most restaurants and shopping malls

* 街电 (Jiedian)

* -- Second largest, strong presence in convenience stores and cafés

* 小电 (Xiaodian)

* -- Popular in smaller shops and tea houses

* 来电 (Laidian)

* -- Often found in bars, KTV, and nightlife venues

* 美团充电宝 (Meituan Power Bank)

* -- Integrated with the Meituan app, convenient for Meituan users

How to Borrow

Method 1: WeChat or Alipay Scan

* Open

* WeChat

* or

* Alipay

* and scan the QR code on the rental station

* Authorize a security deposit -- usually

* ¥99-199

* (refunded when you return the power bank)

* A power bank pops out of the station -- take it and go

Method 2: Meituan App

* Open the

* Meituan (美团)

* app and search for "充电宝" (power bank)

* Find nearby power bank stations on the map

* Scan the QR code at the station to borrow

What You Get:

* Each power bank comes with

* built-in cables

* -- Lightning (iPhone), USB-C (Android/modern devices), and Micro-USB (older devices)

* Capacity is typically

* 5000mAh

* -- enough for roughly one full phone charge

* LED indicators show remaining battery level

Pricing

* First hour is often

* free

* or

* ¥1-2/hour

* After that,

* ¥2-4/hour

* Daily cap usually

* ¥20-30

* -- you won't pay more than this per day

* If you never return it, the deposit is charged and the power bank is yours to keep

How to Return

* Find any station of the

* same brand

* -- it does not have to be the same location where you borrowed

* Insert the power bank into an empty slot -- the rental ends automatically

* Your deposit is refunded and the final charge is calculated

* Use the app to find nearby return stations if you're in an unfamiliar area

Tips:

* Check battery level before borrowing

* -- most stations show LED indicators on each slot; avoid half-dead power banks

* Set a reminder to return

* -- charges add up over hours, especially overnight

* If you

* can't find a return station

* , contact customer service through the app -- they can help locate the nearest one

* NEVER return a power bank to a different brand's station -- a Jiedian power bank will

NOT fit in an Energy Monster station. Always check the brand name on the power bank

before walking to a return station.

* You can check the nearest return location for your brand through the brand's WeChat

mini-program (小程序) -- search for the brand name in WeChat and open the

mini-program to find nearby stations on a map.

* These stations are most common at:

* restaurants, KTV, shopping malls, airports, train stations, and bars

* If the power bank is

* damaged or not working

*, report it immediately through the app to avoid being charged

* Energy Monster (怪兽充电)

* -- ¥1-3/hour, daily cap ¥20 -- Found at: Restaurants, malls

* Jiedian (街电)

* -- ¥1-3/hour, daily cap ¥20 -- Found at: Convenience stores, cafés

* Xiaodian (小电)

* -- ¥2-4/hour, daily cap ¥30 -- Found at: Small shops, tea houses

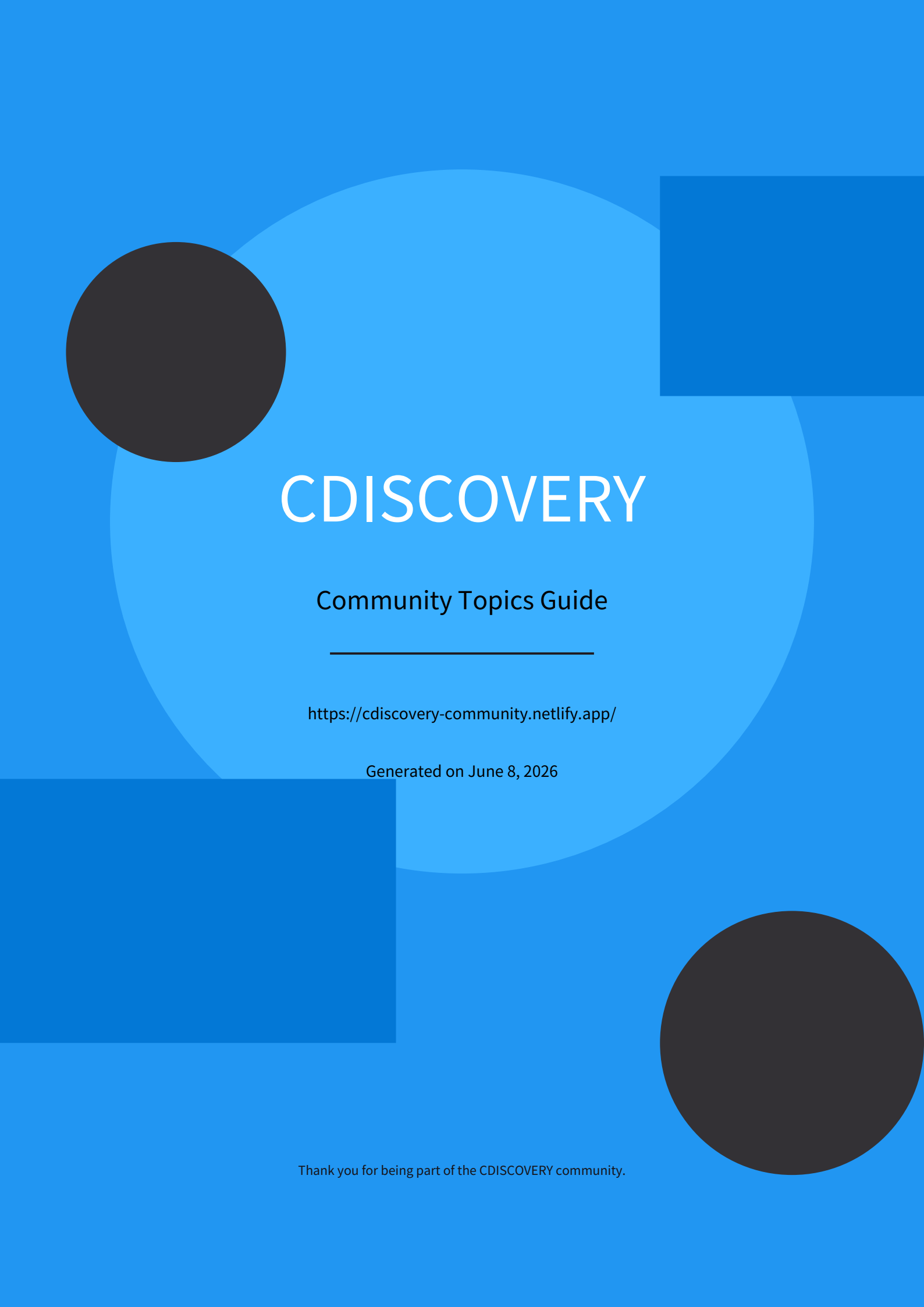
* Laidian (来电)

* -- ¥2-4/hour, daily cap ¥30 -- Found at: Bars, KTV, nightlife

* Meituan Power Bank (美团充电宝)

* -- ¥1-3/hour, daily cap ¥20 -- Found at: Meituan partner venues

Sources: Sources: [怪兽充电 Energy Monster](https://www.zhuanshouchong.com) • [街电 Jiedian](https://www.jiedian.com) • [小电 Xiaodian](https://www.xiaodian.com) • [来电 Laidian](https://www.laidian.com)

The background is a solid blue color. In the center, there is a large, light blue circle. To the left of this circle is a dark grey circle. To the right is a dark blue rectangle. Below the light blue circle is a dark blue rectangle. In the bottom right corner is a dark grey circle. The text "CDISCOVERY" is written in white, bold, sans-serif font across the center of the light blue circle. Below it, "Community Topics Guide" is written in a smaller, black, sans-serif font. A thin black horizontal line is below that. Then, the URL "https://cdiscovery-community.netlify.app/" is written in a smaller, black, sans-serif font. Below the URL, "Generated on June 8, 2026" is written in a very small, black, sans-serif font. At the bottom center, "Thank you for being part of the CDISCOVERY community." is written in a very small, black, sans-serif font.

CDISCOVERY

Community Topics Guide

<https://cdiscovery-community.netlify.app/>

Generated on June 8, 2026

Thank you for being part of the CDISCOVERY community.